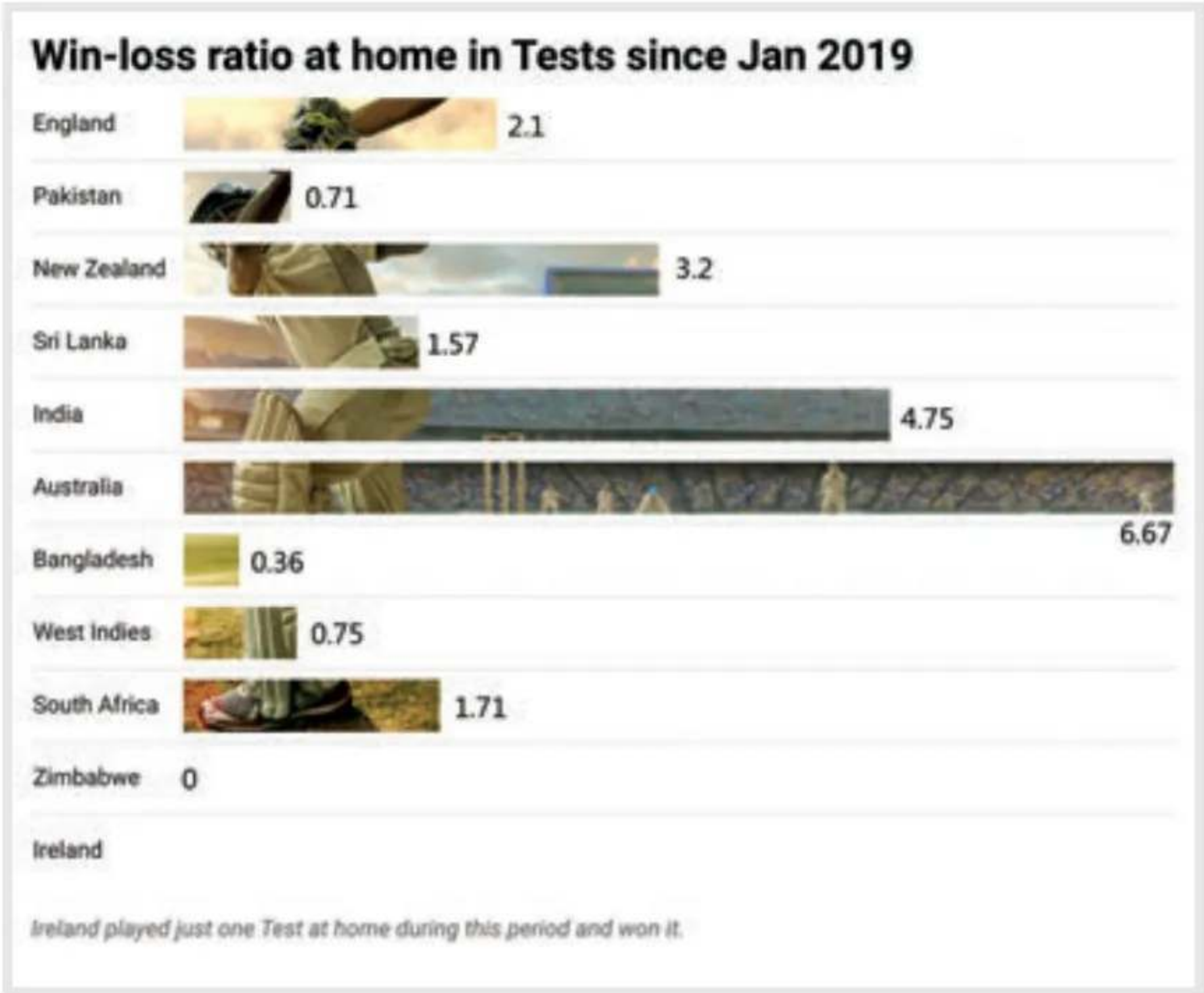




**No country for bowlers:** In the last five years, there have been eight 500+ innings totals in Test cricket in Pakistan, the joint-highest among all countries, alongside Australia. GETTY IMAGES



However, things didn't go as expected. Leg-spinner Abrar Ahmed was the only specialist spinner in the XI, with Pakistan fielding Naseem, Shaheen, and Aamer Jamal to lead the attack. However, with England piling up 823 for 7 — the highest score Pakistan has ever conceded — the plan boomeranged, and as Khan points out, the “team seemed clueless about how to claim ten wickets in those placid conditions.”

In the Multan Test, Pakistan shifted from its pace-centric approach, relying instead on the spin duo of Sajid Khan and Noman Ali. The strategy worked, as all 20 English wickets in the second Test were shared between the two Pakistani spinners, guiding the host to a breakthrough win.

**(All stats updated till second Pakistan vs England Test)**